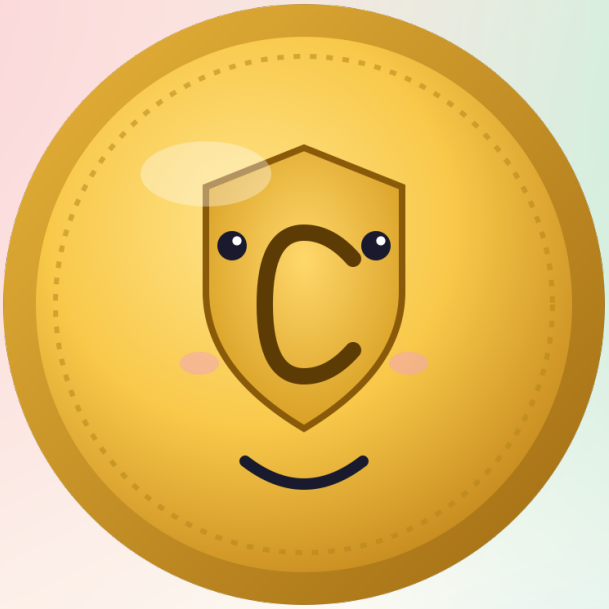


GRADE 2

Teacher Guide

C A S H

Businesses solve problems

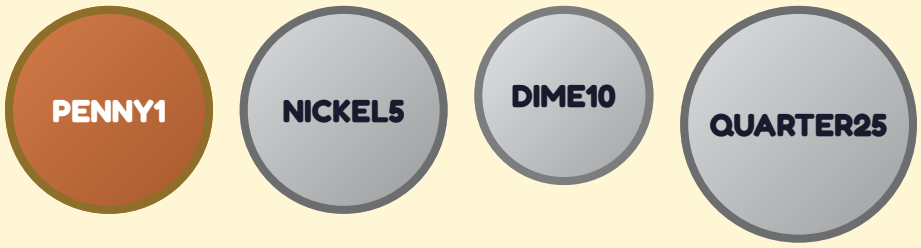
Routines, pacing, and the small moves that work.

Grade 2 — Cash to Company: Teacher Guide

For: second-grade classroom teachers, homeschool parents teaching the curriculum, after-school program leads, paraprofessionals supporting Grade 2 classrooms. **Companion to:** Grade 2 Curriculum Book, Lesson Plans, Student Activity Book, Cash Video Scripts, and Parent Guide.

How this year is built (and why)

Grade 2 of Cash to Company is the **capstone year of the K-2 band.** Kindergarten taught children to notice helpers. Grade 1 taught them to sort businesses into "make a thing" or "do a thing." Grade 2 is the year the noticing turns into entrepreneurial action: **a problem is a thing a business can solve, and somebody can come up with the idea.**



The year is built around one central artifact — the **Problem → Idea card** — and one central event — the **Solve-It Fair**. Everything else (the Problem Wall, the Class Market, the Sign Library, the team skits, the fairness check) feeds into them.

The pedagogical bones are three:

- **Problem-spotting beats idea-generating.** Second graders are full of "ideas." Most of those ideas are not connected to real problems. The year's discipline is to put the problem first. Every Problem → Idea card has the problem on top and the idea below — never the reverse.
- **The Capstone is a real event.** The Solve-It Fair is not a worksheet; it is a public sharing with families. Children rise to public events. Build toward it from Week 28.
- **Peer revision is the LRCI move.** Grade 2's launch-readiness outcome is "ask one classmate what they would change, and write down what they said." That move sits at the heart of Unit 4. It is the seed of every iteration the program will ask of students later — Grade 7's customer feedback, Grade 8's PDSA, Grade 11's pitch revision.

Classroom routines (the year, on autopilot)

Set these in the first three weeks. Protect them.

The "Who solved a problem for us today?" opener

At the start of every Cash to Company block, ask the question. Take 3–5 answers. By Week 6, children will be answering before you ask. Add a sticky to the Problem Wall on Tuesdays.

The Word Wall touch (Mondays and Thursdays, 3 minutes)

Point at one word on the wall. Say it. Children echo. Call on a child to use it in a sentence. Done. Three minutes.

The Coin Moment (Tuesdays during Units 2–4, 5 minutes)

Teacher calls a price under a dollar. Children show the change with coin cards. Three rounds, then done.

Friday Problem of the Week

Read three new problems from the Problem Wall. Children vote (fingers up). Teacher circles the winner. The Problem of the Week sits on the board until the next Friday.

Fairness Check (Fridays during Unit 3, 5 minutes)

Teacher reads a one-paragraph "kid business" story. Children hold up FAIR or NOT FAIR cards. Teacher calls on 2–3 children for reasons.

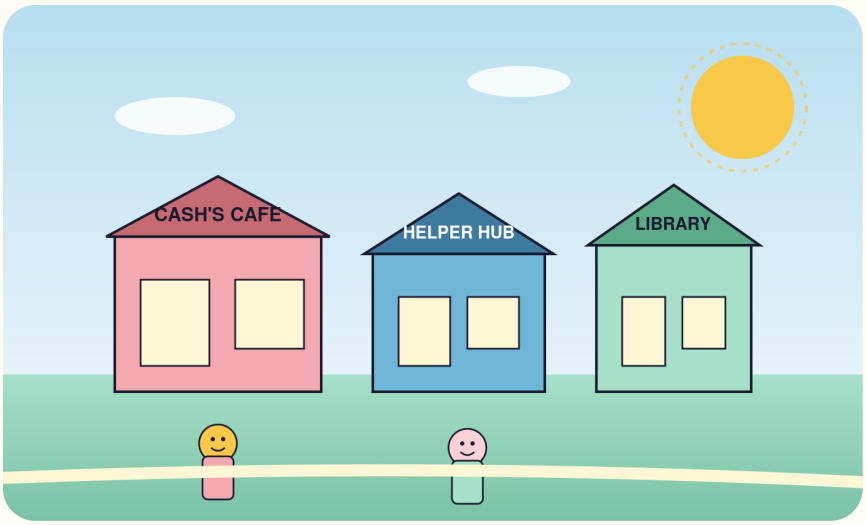
Pedagogy at this grade band

- **Concrete still beats abstract.** A real problem in our school beats a hypothetical problem in a textbook. A real coin in a hand beats a "money" word on a page. A real paper sign on the wall beats a description of signs.
- **Repetition is still friendly.** Second graders thrive on the same chants and questions. "Honest. The same for everybody. No tricks." The teacher says it. The children echo. By Week 24, children say it on their own.
- **Talk, then draw, then write.** Most second graders can write 1–3 sentences. Capture longer answers in adult handwriting on the back of the card. Talking is still the primary assessment.
- **Identity-aware.** Many of the problems children name will touch family hardship. Receive every answer warmly. Move private hardships into a teacher-only note; choose a different public problem with the child for the wall.

- **Movement-based.** Most lessons include children moving — to the rug, to the wall, to a partner desk, to the Class Market booth. Wiggly is the default at 7. Plan for it.
- **Light writing, real ideas.** The Activity Book includes word-lines and short writing prompts, but the bar is one short sentence. Children who write more are not "better"; children who write fewer words and more pictures are doing the same work.

CASH SAYS

Which coin is more? Show me with your hands.



Helpers are everywhere. Each one is a kind of business.

Assessment philosophy

Assessment in Grade 2 is **observation-plus-artifact.** The class checklist (one page, eight columns) is the year's gradebook. Each child has a folder with three artifacts in it by June: the original Problem → Idea card from Unit 1, the revised Problem → Idea card with peer notes from Unit 4, and a representative sign from Unit 3.

We watch for two things:

1. **Did the child do the move the standard names?** Did they actually fill out a Problem → Idea card? Did they actually make change correctly? Did they actually ask a classmate "what would you change"?
2. **Can they tell a grown-up what they did?** Oral report is the Grade 2 version of explanation. A child who can say "My problem was the long lunch line. My idea was a second salad bar. My partner said maybe a snack cart in the hall instead. I think I'll try the snack cart because the salad bar takes a grown-up to staff it." — that child has the year.

We do not grade neatness. We do not grade spelling (most second graders are still learning to spell). We do not assign letter grades or numbers. The checklist is Y / N. By June, most children should have most boxes checked. If a column is empty for many children, we re-teach.

A typical assessment cadence

Cadence	Form	Stakes
Daily	Visible-thinking note	None — formative observation
Weekly	Problem Wall sticky; Cash video reflection	None — observation only
End of unit	Class checklist update + one folder artifact	Low — for teacher's planning and family conferences
End of year	Solve-It Fair + paired Problem → Idea cards	The year's culmination — observation + artifact

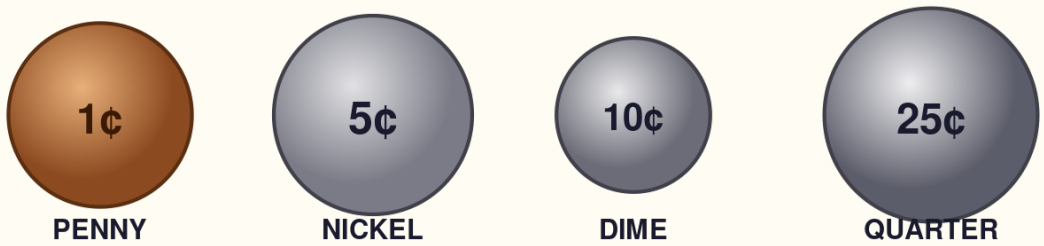
Working with developing readers

- **Read every word out loud the first time.** Second graders are mid-readers. Some can read most of the Activity Book independently; some still need each prompt read aloud. Read every prompt the first time, every time. Pacing is the cost; clarity is the win.
- **Picture cards still beat text cards.** Sorting, matching, sequencing — use cards with pictures, not words alone. (Words can sit alongside the picture as exposure.)
- **Sentence frames are spoken first, written second.** "Problem: **. Idea:** ." Children rehearse out loud, then write.
- **Captions written by the teacher when needed.** When a child draws a problem, ask, "what's happening?" Write the child's words on the line. Read it back.

- **The Word Wall is a touch-and-say wall, then a touch-and-spell wall by spring.** Spelling exposure is good; spelling correctness is not the standard.

Dramatic play and event setup (the most important environments in the room)

The Class Market (Unit 2 capstone) and the Solve-It Fair (Unit 4 capstone) are the year's two big events. Set them up well.



Penny. Nickel. Dime. Quarter. We say each name out loud.

The Class Market corner. - 6–8 small "store stations" around the room (a table or rug-square each). - Per station: a paper sign with the store name, 5–8 paper goods with hand-written prices, a set of coin cards, a paper dollar. - A **Setup Checklist** at every station (see Lesson Plans Lesson 5). - A small bell or chime to open and close the market.

The Solve-It Fair booths. - A folded card stand at each child's desk. - A name sign and the revised Problem → Idea card propped up. - One set of "they said" peer notes attached. - A small badge sticker per child (handed by the teacher after they share with their grown-up).

The Problem Wall. - A bulletin board section dedicated to it from Day 1. - Refill stickies weekly. - Photograph and archive the Problem of the Week to a class folder.

Sound and energy. Both events get loud and excited. That is the work. The expectation: kind words at all times, hands kept to oneself, the fair stays roughly tidy. The teacher's role on the day is calm coaching, not crowd control.

CASH SAYS

What comes first? What comes next?

Classroom management for 7-year-olds (specific to this curriculum)

- **A child says "that's not fair" about something that's actually fair.** Fairness is loaded for second graders. Coach the rule: "Fair to the customer means honest, the same for everybody, no tricks. It does not mean 'I get what I want.'" Use a Fairness Check Friday story to anchor.
- **A child names a "problem" that's a private hardship.** Receive warmly. "That's a real problem. Let's keep that one between you and me. For the wall, pick a problem you can see in our school." Write the private one on a small note for the teacher folder. Tell the school counselor if it's a safeguarding concern.
- **A child makes change wrong and gets frustrated.** Coin chart goes back up. Practice with partner. Use the simplest math first (75¢ → quarter back).

Build up. Mark Y on the checklist as soon as the child gets one round right; ladder up over the unit.

- **A pair argues during peer revision.** Reset the rule: "We listen. We don't argue. We write what they said. We choose later." If the argument continues, separate and pair each with the teacher for one round.
- **A child won't ask the "what would you change?" question.** Don't push immediately. Pair them with a strong peer who can model. Let them watch the question for a day or two. By Week 32, almost every child will ask.
- **The class as a whole drifts during a Cash video.** Pause. Replay the last 30 seconds. Ask the question Cash asked. Continue.
- **A whole-class meltdown on a hard day.** Skip the lesson. Read a picture book from the anchor list. Do a 5-minute coin-chart drill. The day is not lost; the routine carries the year.

Pacing — what to do if you're behind

If you reach Week 18 and the Class Market isn't done, that's normal. Compress: spend Week 19 finishing the market, then start Unit 3 Week 20. The protected territory is **Unit 4** — the Solve-It Fair needs at least 7 weeks to build the revised cards. Do not cut Unit 4 below 7 weeks.

If you reach Week 25 and the Sign Library is empty, prioritize signs in Weeks 26–27. Each child needs at least one sign in the library by the end of Unit 3.

Common pitfalls

- **Letting "ideas" come before "problems."** The year's discipline is the order: problem first, idea second. If you find children writing ideas without problems, slow down. Re-teach the Problem → Idea card structure.

- **Trying to teach business plans.** Save plans for Grade 4. The Problem → Idea card is the only "plan" Grade 2 needs.
- **Trying to teach pricing math.** Save pricing for Grade 5. Grade 2's math is one move: change from a dollar.
- **Skipping the Cash videos.** The videos are 2:00–2:30. They do real work. They are short on purpose. Watch them.
- **Reading the Activity Book aloud as if children can all follow.** Some can; some can't. Read every prompt the first time. Slow down.
- **Letting the Solve-It Fair drift into a craft fair.** It is not a craft fair. Children are presenting an idea in response to a problem they noticed. Keep the focus on the card, not the booth's decoration.
- **Asking children about family income.** Don't. Ever. Family money is off-limits at every grade.
- **Avoiding fairness conversations because they get heated.** The year teaches fair-to-customer specifically. Heated is fine; coach the rule. The discomfort is the curriculum.

CASH SAYS

Tell me what they said with their words.

Frequently asked questions

My class includes a wide range of readers — some can read fluently, some can't. How do I run the Activity Book? Read every page aloud the first time.

Strong readers won't be insulted. Developing readers won't be left out. By spring, most children can read most of the prompts on their own; let them.

A family asked if their child can interview a parent about a problem the parent solved at work. Sure. Send the child home with a Problem → Idea card. The child writes "Problem: ___ at my parent's work. Idea: ___." The parent helps. Add to the wall (with permission and no naming of confidential workplace info).

A child has a fine-motor delay and struggles with writing. Provide pre-printed sentence frames stamped on the cards. The child fills the blanks orally; the teacher writes. The child draws. The artifact is still the child's choice.

The school doesn't have real coins. Use coin cards for the whole year. Real coins are nice but not required.

One child can already make change with mixed coins for prices over a dollar. Push them. Have them be the "manager" at the Class Market — they walk a clipboard around, check setup checklists, and answer change questions for younger kids.

The Problem Wall has a problem that names a specific child as the problem. Take it down quietly. Replace with a re-stated version of the same issue ("kids in our class sometimes don't share at recess") that doesn't name a specific person. Talk to the writer privately.

Family Visit Day is a hardship for some families. Pair the child with a teacher buddy or another family. The point is the telling, not who tells. Make this normal — many children will be paired this way, and no child should feel singled out.

A child wants to make money for real on their idea. Encourage but don't require. The Solve-It Fair is not a real market; it's a sharing event. If a child wants to actually try their idea (a snack stand at a school event, a bracelet table at a fair), support it as an extension — that's the program working.

Cross-grade hook (what this year sets up for Grade 3)

Grade 3's theme is "Business ideas come from skills, hobbies, and needs." In Grade 2, children notice problems in their school. In Grade 3, they connect those problems to their own skills and hobbies and start generating multiple ideas per problem.

The bridge is sturdy:

- The **Problem → Idea card** becomes the **Skills + Hobbies + Needs web.**
- "What would you change?" (Grade 2) becomes "Why did you pick this idea?" (Grade 3 — students defend their pick with a reason).
- The **Class Market** (Grade 2 — change from a dollar) becomes the **Profit math** (Grade 3 — cost, revenue, profit on a single lemonade-stand scenario).
- The **fair-to-the-customer rule** (Grade 2 — honest, the same for everybody) becomes the **honest vs. misleading check** (Grade 3 — "100% juice" vs. "juice drink").

A strong Grade 2 makes Grade 3 dramatically easier. Plant the routines. Trust the spine.

Cross-grade hook (what Grade 1 set up that you inherit)

Grade 1's children sorted businesses into "makes a thing" or "does a thing." Your Grade 2 students arrive knowing that the bakery makes bread (and does the kneading) and the librarian does book-lending (without making books). They can

already match a business sign to a kind of helper. The piece they don't yet have is the problem behind it: the bakery solves the problem of "I want bread for dinner." The librarian solves the problem of "I want a book to read." Build on what they know. Don't re-teach the sort. Use it.

CASH SAYS

Notice, notice, notice. What did you see?

A note to first-time teachers of this curriculum

You do not need any business background. You need to point at problems and ask, "what could a helper do about that?" That is the year. Cash will do the heavy lifting on the videos. The lesson plans take the pacing decisions off your plate. By Week 12, the children will be naming problems in your school you didn't even notice. That is the moment Grade 2 starts working — when the teacher learns from the room what to teach next.

By the Solve-It Fair, your students will have done eight things: noticed a problem, named a helper, made a card, made change from a dollar, used a setup checklist, drawn a sign, taken a team role, and asked a classmate what to change. Each one is small. Together, they are the entrepreneurial habit, in seven-year-old size. The rest of Cash to Company is built on what you plant this year.

Senior expert upgrade pack — Differentiation deep moves (Grade 2)

Advanced learners — three named extensions

1. **Two-problem comparison.** For a student who finds one problem easily, ask for two — and which they think is bigger and why. Builds the priority-thinking that anchors Grade 4 and Grade 9 work.
2. **Sign re-design.** Take an existing real-world sign and redesign it for a different audience (younger, older, ELL, blind/low-vision). "How would you make this sign work for someone who doesn't read English yet?" Builds CBM segmentation seeds.
3. **Boss/worker/customer interview.** The advanced student conducts a 3-question micro-interview with a parent or community member playing one of the three roles. Three questions, written down. This is Grade 7's customer interview, in baby form.

ELL deep moves

- **Picture-first problem.** Allow problem statements as a drawing first, then a sentence.
- **Cognate seeds.** Spanish problema, idea, cliente, justo. Most Grade 2 vocabulary has cognates.
- **Allow problem statements in the home language.** A picture + a home-language phrase + the English equivalent on the side.

IEP/504 deep moves

- **Coin-value chart taped to the desk for change-making.** Children consult; that's fine.

- **Pre-printed problem-card template.** Three boxes: what's wrong / who it bothers / one idea. Reduces blank-page paralysis.
- **Sensory-aware Solve-It Fair.** Some children get overwhelmed at a loud public fair. Offer a quiet pre-fair preview with one trusted adult.

"What to do when a student names a problem that's actually about another student"

Three concrete moves:

1. **Re-frame the problem at the level of the system, not the person.** "It sounds like the playground rules don't always work. What's a rule that could help everyone?"
2. **Anonymize.** "Let's not use names. The problem is `someone is being left out at recess.` That's a problem businesses solve all the time — what could help?"
3. **Refer if needed.** If the problem is about safety, bullying, or harm, this is a counselor referral, not a curriculum lesson. The Cash to Company moment ends; the school's response begins.

CASH

Which people, and how do you know?

ROUND 2 PATCH — Cash Never Says (Teacher Reference Card)

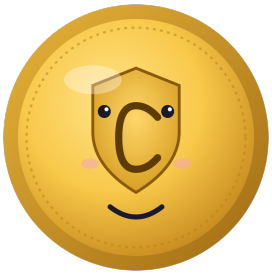
Cash to Company holds a hard line on the language we use about money, work, and ventures. The brand sets the tone; the classroom matches it. Print this on the inside cover of your Teacher Guide.

Cash never says: "Amazing!" / "Awesome!" / "Crushing it!" / "Boss up" / "Get that bag" / "Everyone can be rich" / "Anyone can be a millionaire" / "Easy money" / "Passive income" / "Financial freedom" / "Just believe" / "Believe in yourself" (as a substitute for evidence) / "If you can dream it, you can do it" / "Money is fun!" (alone) / "Side hustle" (use "side venture") / wealth-flexing language / anything implying wealth is a matter of mindset or hustle / anything implying low-income or unbanked families are at fault.

Cash always asks: "Which people, and how do you know?" / "What did they actually say?" / "Whats the evidence?" / "What would have to be true for you to be right?" / "What would have to be true for you to be wrong?" / "Whats one thing youd change?"

Teacher mirror: When you praise, mirror Cashs voice. Say "okay, thats specific — whats the evidence?" instead of "great job!" Specific feedback beats enthusiasm every time.

Cashs three signature physical moves: (1) **Notebook Tilt** — turning the clipboard toward camera before reading a quote; (2) **Two-Finger Tap** — tapping a number twice when emphasizing it; (3) **Slow Lean** — leaning toward camera before a contrarian truth. Point students to these the first time you watch a Cash video.



Which people, and how do you know?

— CASH

CASH TO COMPANY

Which people, and how do you know?

Cash is the friendly coin who helps us notice, ask, and try again. Cash will be with us all year. — Grade 2